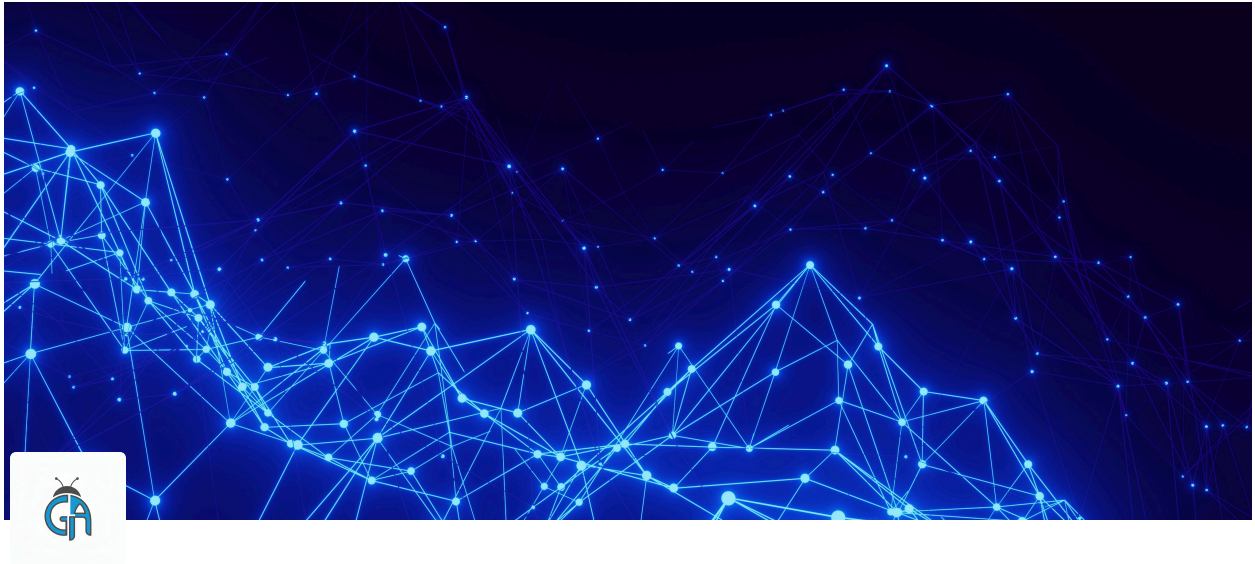




Shift Left Testing

Testing Early, Saving Money

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TL;DR

Traditionally, testing happens at the **end** of the project (Right side of the timeline).

Shift Left means moving testing to the **start** (Left side).

We test requirements and designs *before* code is even written to prevent bugs instead of just finding them.

The Core Concept

Imagine the software development lifecycle as a timeline from Left to Right.

The Old Way (Waterfall):

[Requirements] → [Design] → [Coding] → [Testing] → [Release]

Problem: If we find a design bug during the "Testing" phase, we have to undo weeks of coding.

The Shift Left Way:

[Requirements + Test] → [Design + Test] → [Coding + Test] → [Release]

Solution: QA is involved from Day 1. We ask questions about the requirements to catch logic gaps immediately.

The Cost of Quality (Why we do it)

The cost to fix a bug grows **exponentially** over time.

- **Phase: Requirements** → Cost: **\$1**
 - - *Fix:* Just delete a sentence in a document.
- **Phase: Coding** → Cost: **\$10**
 - - *Fix:* Rewrite a function.
- **Phase: Testing** → Cost: **\$100**
 - - *Fix:* Developer stops work, fixes it, QA retests, Regression test.
- **Phase: Production** → Cost: **\$10,000+**
 - - *Fix:* Hotfix, downtime, lost customers, bad reputation.

Shift Left pushes bug detection to the \$1 phase.

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The Construction Analogy

The Old Way:

You build the entire house. Then, the inspector comes in and says, "The foundation is cracked. Tear it down and start over."

(Huge waste of money).

Shift Left:

The inspector looks at the **blueprints** before you pour the concrete. He says, "This foundation design is too weak for this soil. Change the drawing."

(Cost: One eraser).

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Real World Example: The "Login" Button

Scenario: The Designer creates a mockup for a login page but forgets the "Forgot Password" link.

Traditional Tester:

Waits 2 weeks for the developer to build it.

Tests it.

"Bug: There is no way to reset the password."

Result: Developer has to go back and add code.

Shift Left Tester:

Looks at the **design mockup** on Day 1.

"Question: Where is the 'Forgot Password' link?"

Result: Designer adds it to the drawing. Developer builds it correctly the first time.

Zero code rework.

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Why This Matters to Me

My job isn't just to *break* the software; it's to help *build* it correctly.

I practice Shift Left by joining the **"Three Amigos"** meetings (Product + Dev + QA) and asking: *"How are we going to test this?"* before a single line of code is written.